



PHOTOS BY **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**

aim to increase to build 100 km per day—this will happen next year. I'm not just saying that; we are working toward this target. To achieve this, the most important thing is our contract awards—we have awarded projects worth about ₹2.5 lakh crore so far this year, and by March end, we will have awarded contracts worth ₹10 lakh crore for

road construction. If we do projects worth ₹10 lakh crore, I believe that for every rupee spent on infrastructure, ₹3.80 is generated economically. This is what our economists say.

The most important achievement is that IIM Bangalore, IIT Chennai and IIT Kanpur conducted studies, and all three said that India's road logistics

costs have reduced by 6%. Earlier, our logistics cost was 16%; it is 12% in the US and Europe, and 8% in China. I believe that by this December, our logistics cost will come down to 9%. Thanks to better roads, speed has increased and time saved, so the logistics cost will definitely come below 7%. This will increase our exports by 1.5 times or will

possibly double.

We are also working on alternative fuels and biofuels. For mass rapid transport on electricity—we have awarded a contract to the Tata group for flash-charging buses. For the first time in the country, a 135-seater bus running on flash charging is starting as a pilot in Nagpur. Soon, these buses will start plying on routes